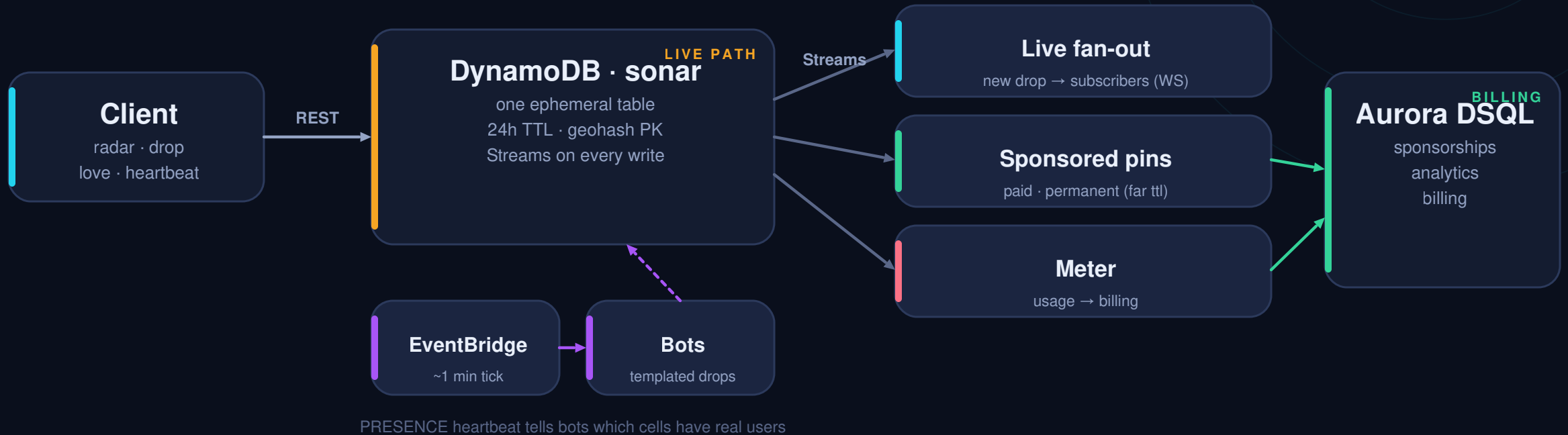


How Sonar's data layer works



One ephemeral table keeps the live radar fast; likes buy a drop more time, and sponsored pins are the only permanent waypoints.

What's near me

1 query × 9 cells

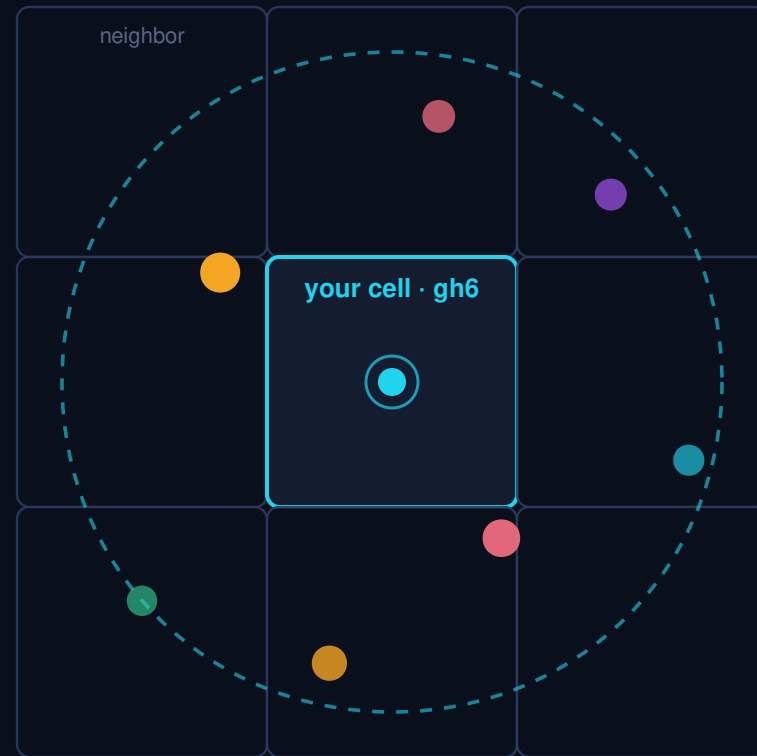
your cell + 8 neighbors, per channel

merge & rank

proximity + freshness, client-side

exact distance

haversine in the browser → color



COLOR = DISTANCE

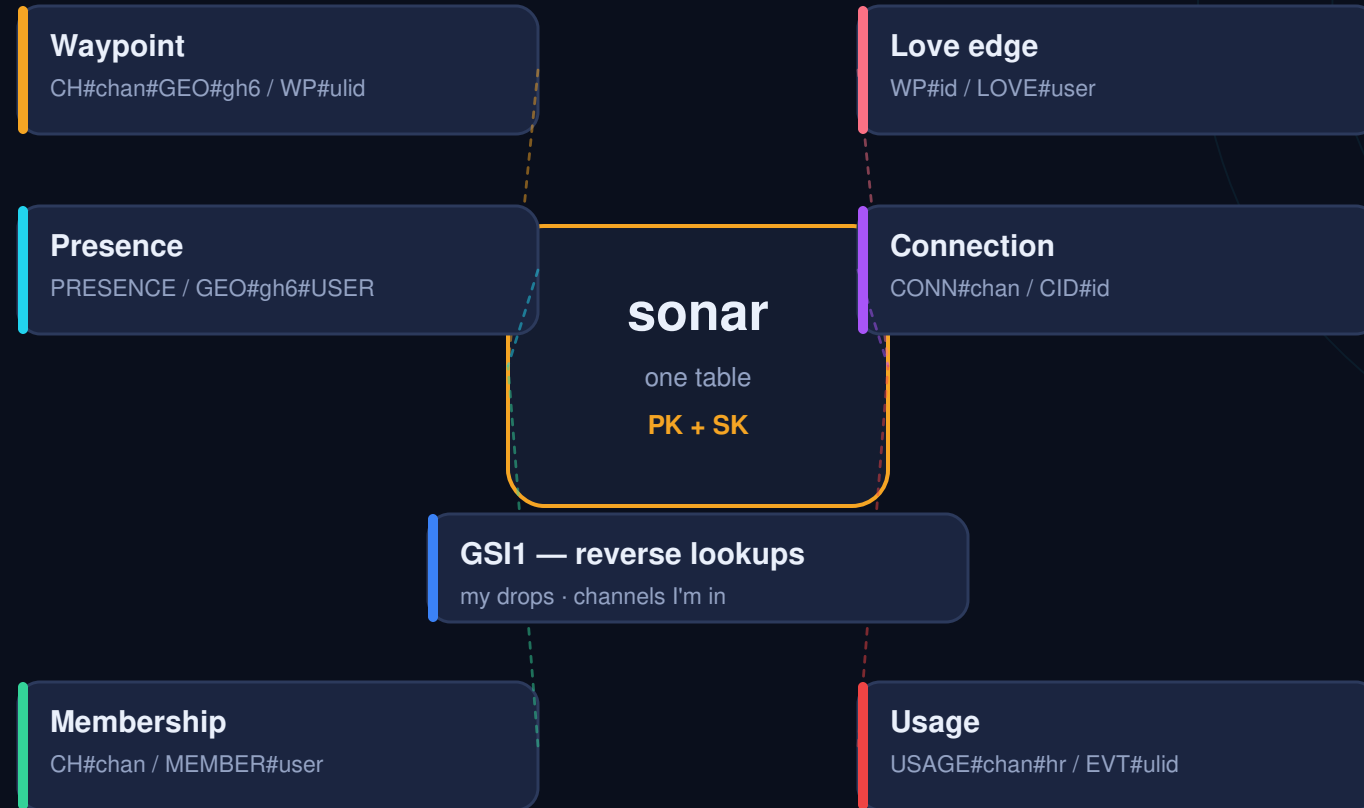


far

near

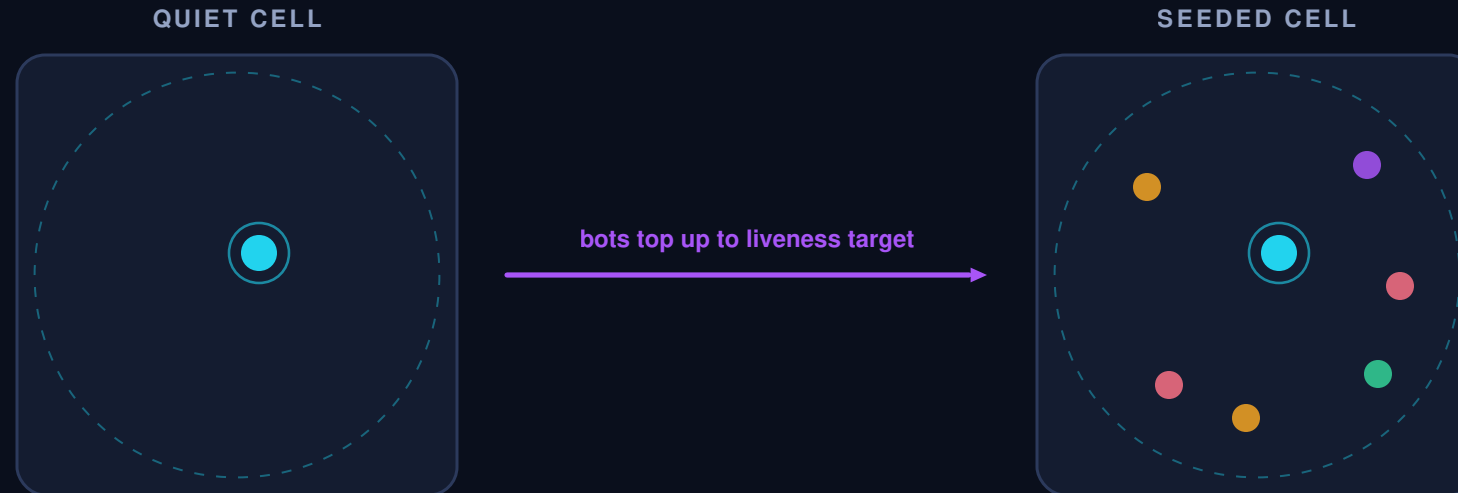
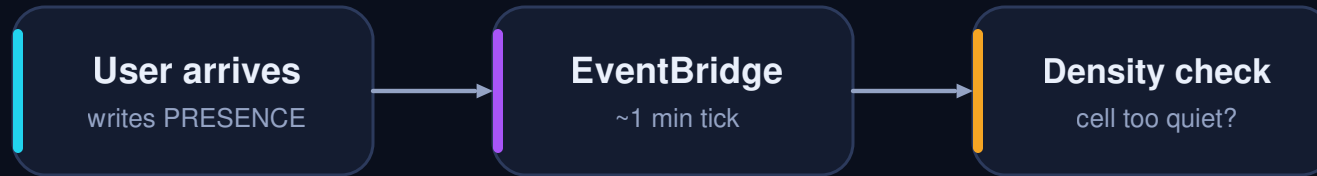
The world is a grid of geohash cells. Query your cell plus its 8 neighbors, then color each drop by real distance.

One table, many shapes



DynamoDB holds six item types under one key schema — the key prefix IS the type. Access patterns drive the design, not entities.

Bots seed the place reactively



tagged actorType=bot

24h TTL cleans them up · never billed · can't buy time

No pre-seeded world. When a real user shows up to a quiet cell, bots fill it so the radar is never empty.

Likes rent time · sponsors buy permanence



Drops start at 24h; each human like adds +5 min (uncapped). Nothing user-posted lasts forever — the only permanent pins are sponsored.